

Ideation and Audits

Ideation

The process of generating a broad set of ideas on a given topic, with no attempt to judge or evaluate them



2000



Today

Ideation in the real world

- Brainstorm out loud
- Document all ideas
- Focus on quantity
- Do not allow evaluation
- Gather a diverse team
- Question the obvious
- Evaluate the ideas

Problem

Olivia is a parent who needs a way to ride her bike with her 2-year-old Luca because he can't ride his own bike.



Crazy Eights

Charles is a retired grandfather who needs a way to keep his essential belongings with him because he often loses track of his wallet.

ALARM

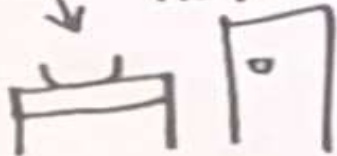


↑
FALSE
BOTTOM

"DAD,
PUT THIS
PHONE IN
POCKET!"



↓
PUT THINGS
HERE!



Amal is an athlete who needs a way to sign up for workout classes, because the class he wants to participate in fills up fast.

How Might We?

- “How” - Explore a bunch of ideas
- “Might” - Our ideas are possible solutions, not the only solution
- “We” - Collaborative effort

How might we design a seat for a child to ride a bike with an adult?

How might we design a safe, forward-facing seat that attaches to an adult's bicycle, so a child can choose to ride or sleep while an adult rides on a mountain trail?

How might we design a safe and comfortable seat for a child to ride a bike with an adult?

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Shane is a busy professional and book lover
user name user characteristics

who needs to easily find and reserve books online
user need

because they want their book to be available
to pick up at the library .
insight

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Dakota

user name

is a

self-employed artist

user characteristics

who needs

to connect with customers online

user need

because they want to sell their paintings outside of the city.

insight

Why should we come up with a lot of ideas?

- List of ideas is narrowed based on constraints
- Need to focus on equity
- Let users test the ideas

Competitive audit

An overview of your competitors' strengths and weaknesses

- Identifying your key competitors
- Reviewing the products that your competitors offer
- Understanding how your competitors position themselves in the market
- Examining what your competition does well and what they could do better

Direct competitors

Have offerings that are similar to your product and focus on the same audience

Indirect competitors

Have a similar set of offerings but focus on a different audience, or have a different set of offerings and focus on the same audience

Benefits to competitive audits

- Inform your design process
- Solve usability problems
- Reveal gaps in the market
- Provide reliable evidence
- Save time, money, and energy

Competitive audit steps

1. Outline the goals
2. Create a spreadsheet with a list of your competitors
3. Call out the specific features you want to compare
4. Research each company
5. Analyze findings
6. Summarize findings in a report

Limitations of competitive audits

- Stifle creativity
- Depend on how well you interpret the findings
- Not all designs work in all use cases
- Need to be done regularly

Use the learnings from our competitive audit to come up with even more ideas

- Take your team through the matrix
 - Identify low hanging fruit
 - Brainstorm gaps or opportunities
 - Sort ideas
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User journey

The series of experiences a user has while interacting with a product